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The Bookkeeping Prep Client Kit

Install receipt chasing, expense categorizing, invoice reminders and a month-end summary for a client, ready for their bookkeeper

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Before you start

Small business owners hate the monthly money admin: hunting for receipts, sorting transactions, chasing unpaid invoices and trying to work out how the month went. Their bookkeeper hates it too, because they get a shoebox instead of a clean file.

This kit sets up four AI agents that do the prep work, so the bookkeeper gets clean, categorized, flagged files and the owner gets a plain-English summary of the month. It does **not** replace a bookkeeper or accountant, and you should never sell it as if it does. It's the admin layer around them, which is exactly where a VA adds value. It comes with the pitch, numbers, intake, tests, handover and monthly care plan to sell it as a service.

What this kit installs

Agent	What it does	Runs	Saves a month
Receipt and Document Chaser	Finds missing receipts and drafts the ask	Mondays, 10:10am	1.5 hrs · $53
Expense Categorizer	Sorts transactions into the client's categories	Monthly, the 3rd	3.5 hrs · $123
Invoice Reminder Agent	Drafts the right reminder for each overdue invoice	Mondays, 9:10am	2 hrs · $64
Month-End Summary Agent	Explains the month in plain English	Monthly, after the books close	2.25 hrs · $128

*Total for a typical small business: **about 9 hours and $368 a month**, with review time already subtracted. How the numbers are worked out is in Part 1.*

Who to sell it to

- **Owners who send their bookkeeper a mess every month** and pay for the hours it takes to sort it.
- **Service businesses with lots of invoices** and a habit of paying late reminders late.
- **Clients whose bookkeeper or accountant is happy to have help.** Talk to the bookkeeper early; they'll tell you what format they want, and they often refer other clients.

What you need before you start

- **Your own paid Claude or ChatGPT account** to practice on. Build every agent once for yourself before you install it for a client.

- **The client on their own paid plan** (about $20 a month for one person). The agents, files and connections live in the client's account, not yours, so they keep working if you part ways and the client's data never sits in your account.
- **A conversation with the client's bookkeeper or accountant** before you start, so your files fit how they work.
- **Read access only.** Nothing in this kit needs permission to change the books, move money or send invoices. Don't accept more access than that.

How to use this kit

1. **Part 1, Sell it:** the pitch, the savings worksheet, what to charge and a proposal email.
2. **Part 2, Intake:** the questions to ask, the access to request and the safety rules to agree in writing.
3. **Part 3, Install:** 4 agents, each with instructions to paste, files to collect, connections and a scheduled task.
4. **Part 4, Test:** the checks to run before the client sees anything.
5. **Part 5, Hand it over:** a client-facing guide and a 20-minute handover call.
6. **Part 6, Keep it running:** a weekly care checklist, a 30-day results report and what to sell next.

Every agent works in Claude or ChatGPT. Where the steps differ, both are shown. Fill in every [bracket] before you paste anything.

The one rule

Agents draft. People approve. No reminder is sent, no transaction is changed and no money moves without a person approving it, and the bookkeeper or accountant still owns the books. You can loosen this later for one agent at a time, once it has a clean record (Part 6 shows how).

Part 1: Sell it

The 30-second pitch

> **Script: The pitch**
>
> "Every month you're hunting for receipts, your bookkeeper is sorting transactions you could have pre-sorted, and late invoices sit there because nobody chased them. I can set up AI in your own account that finds missing receipts every Monday, sorts your transactions for your bookkeeper, drafts the right reminder for every overdue invoice and gives you a one-page summary of the month in plain English. You and your bookkeeper stay in control of everything. Most owners get paid faster and spend a lot less time on it."

Work out their numbers

Clients buy time and money, not AI. Ask how long each job takes today, then fill in this worksheet with them on the call. The figures below are for a typical small business; replace them with the client's own.

Job	Minutes by hand	Minutes to review	Times a month	Rate	Saved a month
Chase missing receipts	30 a week	8 a week	4	$35	1.5 hrs · $53
Categorize transactions	300 a month	90 a month	1	$35	3.5 hrs · $123
Check overdue invoices and write reminders	45 a week	15 a week	4	$32	2 hrs · $64
Understand the month	180 a month	45 a month	1	$57	2.25 hrs · $128

$35 is a bookkeeping clerk ($24.36 median pay plus benefits), $32 a bill and account collector ($22.61), and $57 an accountant ($40.23). Rates are U.S. median pay from the Bureau of Labor Statistics (May 2025) divided by 0.70 to include benefits and payroll taxes. If the owner does the work themselves, their time is worth more, so use their number.

Savings math

Hours saved a month = (minutes by hand − minutes to review) × times a month ÷ 60

Monthly savings = hours saved × hourly rate

For this kit: about 9 hours and $368 a month. The bigger win usually isn't time: if consistent reminders get $20,000 of open invoices paid ten days sooner, that's cash in the bank when it's needed. That isn't counted, and neither is a shorter bill from an hourly bookkeeper

What to charge

Charge for the result and the risk you take off the client's plate, not your hours. A fixed setup fee plus a monthly care plan works best: the client knows the price up front, and you get paid to keep the agents improving.

	Suggested starting range	What it covers
Setup	$400 to $800	Bookkeeper conversation, vendor list, install of all four agents, testing, handover call
Monthly care	$150 to $350 a month	Running the monthly exports, weekly checks, fixes, monthly results report
Smaller start	$200 to $350	Invoice reminders only: often pays for itself in the first month of faster payments

These are starting points, not market rates. Set your own based on your experience, the client's size and how much the work saves them. A good test: the setup fee should pay for itself in under three months of savings.

The proposal email

Template: Proposal email

Subject: Cleaner books and faster payments: bookkeeping prep setup

Hi [first name],

Thanks for walking me through [the job, e.g., chasing receipts, sorting transactions and following up on invoices]. From what you told me, it takes about [hours] hours a month, which costs roughly $[amount] at [rate].

Here's what I'd set up: four AI agents in your own account that find missing receipts every Monday, sort each month's transactions into your categories for your bookkeeper, draft the right reminder for every overdue invoice, and write a plain-English summary of each month. Your bookkeeper still reviews and posts everything; I've spoken with [bookkeeper name] about the format they want.

Setup: $[fee], one time. Done within [5 to 10] business days of getting access.
Monthly care: $[fee] a month. I check the agents every week, fix what needs fixing, update them as your business changes, and send you a short results report each month. Cancel any time with 30 days' notice.

Everything is built in your own [Claude / ChatGPT] account, so you own it. Nothing gets sent to anyone without a person approving it first.

If that works for you, reply "yes" and I'll send the invoice and a short intake form.

[Your name]

Part 2: Intake and access

Send the intake form as soon as the client says yes. Most installs that go wrong go wrong here: missing files, the wrong account or unclear rules.

Intake questionnaire

Send these as a form or a shared document. The first five are the same for every kit.

1. Which AI tool and plan do you use, or should we start one? (Claude Pro or ChatGPT Plus is enough to start.)
2. Which email, calendar and file storage do you use? (Gmail, Outlook, Google Drive, OneDrive, Dropbox.)
3. Who on your team will review what the agents draft, and how quickly can they usually do it?
4. Describe your business in two sentences: what you sell and who buys it.
5. Share three emails or posts you wrote that sound exactly like you.
6. Who is your bookkeeper or accountant, and may I contact them about the format they want?
7. Which accounting software do you use (QuickBooks, Xero, FreshBooks, a spreadsheet)? Which bank and cards?
8. Which transactions need a receipt (a dollar threshold, or certain categories)? Where do receipts go today?
9. Who has a company card? List each card's last four digits and the person who uses it.
10. What are your payment terms, and how do clients pay? Any clients we should never send reminders to?
11. Which numbers do you want to see each month, and what questions do you usually have for your bookkeeper?

Access checklist

Ask the client to invite you, never to send you their password. Where a tool allows it, get your own login with only the access you need.

- ☐ The client's AI account: a seat on their Team plan, or a screen-share session where they log in and you drive.
- ☐ A shared folder for receipts, monthly statement exports and the aging report.
- ☐ Monthly CSV exports of each bank and card account (the client downloads them, or gives you read-only bank access if their bank offers it).
- ☐ Read-only access to the accounting software, if the client and bookkeeper agree. Never edit access.

- ☐ Email connected for drafting reminders.
- ☐ A shared folder (Google Drive or OneDrive) called "AI agents" for the reference files in Part 3.
- ☐ A written yes to the safety rules below.

Safety rules to agree in writing

Put these in your proposal or send them as a short email and ask the client to reply "agreed." They protect the client and they protect you.

> **Template: Safety rules**
>
> 1. Agents draft; a named person approves before anything is sent, posted, paid or deleted.
> 2. The agents and their files live in [client]'s account. [VA name] can be removed at any time.
> 3. These are never pasted into an AI tool: passwords, full card or bank account numbers, Social Security or tax ID numbers, medical records, or anything a contract says to keep confidential.
> 4. Paid AI plans let you turn off use of your chats for training. We'll check that setting on day one.
> 5. No agent has permission to change the books, move money, issue invoices or record payments. The bookkeeper or accountant posts and reconciles everything.
> 6. Agents don't give tax, legal or financial advice. Questions go to the client's accountant.
> 7. Full bank account numbers and card numbers are never uploaded. Statements are exported with only the last four digits.
>
> Agreed by [client name], [date].

Check the privacy setting on day one. In Claude, open **Settings** → **Privacy**; in ChatGPT, open **Settings** → **Data controls**. Turn off the option that lets the provider use chats to improve its models, if the client's plan shows one. Names of menus change often; if you can't find it, ask the assistant "Where do I turn off training on my chats?"

Part 3: Install

Every agent below is built from the same four parts: a **project** (one home for one job), **instructions** (its job description), **files** (its training binder) and, for recurring work, a **schedule**. Connected apps are the fifth part for agents that need them.

The build steps, once

In Claude: Projects → Create project → name it → paste the instructions under Instructions → upload the files → start a chat and give it one small real task. To schedule a task, type in any chat "Every weekday at 7:10am, do the following..." and approve the task Claude proposes, or create it from the Scheduled section.

In ChatGPT: New project → name it → paste the instructions in the project's settings → add the files → test it. To schedule, type "Every weekday at 7:10am, do the following..." and confirm the card, or use the Scheduled section. Two limits to plan for: Plus allows a handful of active scheduled tasks at once, and a scheduled task may not be able to read a project's uploaded files, so every task prompt in this kit is written to stand on its own.

Set scheduled times a few minutes past the hour (7:10, not 7:00) and run each task once by hand before you trust the schedule. Menus get renamed often; if a button isn't where this kit says, ask the assistant where it went.

Install order: Start with the Invoice Reminder Agent: it shows value in the first week. Then the Receipt Chaser, then the Expense Categorizer at the start of the next month, then the Month-End Summary once the books close.

Agent 1: Receipt and Document Chaser

Runs: Mondays, 10:10am · **Needs:** a transaction export and the receipts folder · **Install time:** 30 minutes

What it does: Compares the week's card and bank transactions with the receipts folder, lists everything missing a receipt, and drafts a short message to the owner (or team member) asking for them.

1. Create a project called "Receipt and Document Chaser" in the client's account.

2. Paste these instructions:

> **Instructions: Receipt and Document Chaser**
>
> You keep [business]'s receipts complete for the bookkeeper.
>
> Compare the uploaded transaction export with the receipts in [folder]. A transaction needs a receipt if it's over $[amount, e.g., 75] or in these categories: [e.g., meals, travel, equipment]. Match by amount and date (within 3 days) and vendor name.
>
> **List:** every transaction with no matching receipt: date, vendor, amount, card, who probably spent it (from the card list). **Draft:** one short, friendly message per person asking for their missing receipts, with the list.
>
> Never delete or rename files. Never mark a receipt as found unless you can see it.

3. Upload: the card list (which card belongs to whom) and the receipt rules from intake.

4. Connect: Google Drive or OneDrive, for the receipts folder. Email, if you want the reminders created as drafts.

5. Put it on a schedule:

> **Scheduled task: Missing receipts · Mondays, 10:10am**
>
> **Job:** Find last week's transactions with no receipt. **Read:** the newest transaction export and the receipts in [folder]. **Steps:** (1) List transactions over $[amount] or in [categories]. (2) Match each to a receipt by amount, date (within 3 days) and vendor. (3) List the unmatched ones by cardholder. (4) Draft one friendly reminder per cardholder. **Deliver:** the list and the drafts. **Never** send, post, delete or change anything. If something you need is missing, say exactly what's missing and stop.

Watch for: false matches on round amounts (two $50 charges in one week). When in doubt the agent should list it as missing; a reminder is cheaper than a lost receipt.

Agent 2: Expense Categorizer

Runs: Monthly, the 3rd · **Needs:** a bank or card statement export (CSV) · **Install time:** 45 minutes

What it does: Sorts last month's transactions into the client's own bookkeeping categories and flags duplicates, unusual amounts, personal-looking purchases and new vendors, so the bookkeeper starts from a clean file.

1. Create a project called "Expense Categorizer" in the client's account.

2. Paste these instructions:

> **Instructions: Expense Categorizer**
>
> You prepare monthly transactions for [business]'s bookkeeper. Categories are in the "Chart of accounts" file; known vendors and their usual category are in the "Vendor list" file.
>
> For each transaction, assign a category **from our list only**. If a vendor is new or unclear, mark it REVIEW with your best guess and why.
>
> **Flag:** possible duplicates, amounts more than double that vendor's usual, personal-looking purchases, anything over $[amount], and refunds.
>
> **Output:** a spreadsheet with date, vendor, amount, category, confidence (high or REVIEW) and notes, then a summary of totals by category and the list of flags. Never change an amount, merge transactions or drop one. The row count and total must match the statement.

3. Upload: the chart of accounts and a vendor list. To build the vendor list fast, export last year's categorized transactions from the accounting software and ask the agent to make one.

4. Connect: Drive or OneDrive for the statement exports. If the client's accounting software has a connector on their plan, the agent can read categories directly, but keep it read-only.

Watch for: the totals. Before handing the file over, check the row count and total match the bank statement. The bookkeeper still reviews and posts every transaction.

Agent 3: Invoice Reminder Agent

Runs: Mondays, 9:10am · **Needs:** the accounts receivable aging report · **Install time:** 40 minutes

What it does: Checks who owes the client money every week and drafts the right reminder for each overdue invoice: friendly at 7 days, direct at 30, and a call script for the owner after 45.

1. Create a project called "Invoice Reminder Agent" in the client's account.

2. Paste these instructions:

> **Instructions: Invoice Reminder Agent**
>
> You prepare payment reminders for [business]. Payment terms: [e.g., net 15]. How to pay: [payment link or details].
>
> **Reminder ladder:** 1 to 7 days overdue: friendly note with the invoice and payment link. 8 to 30 days: polite and direct, ask for a payment date. 31 to 45 days: firm, restate our terms, offer a payment plan if [name] allows it. Over 45 days: no email; write a short call script and flag it for [name].
>
> Each reminder: under 100 words, invoice number, amount, due date, how to pay. Warm and professional. Never threaten, mention collections or legal action, or add fees that aren't in our terms.
>
> **Never remind:** [exceptions, e.g., clients on payment plans, anyone [name] wants to call personally].

3. Upload: the payment terms and one reminder email the client has sent before.

4. Connect: the accounting software if a connector is available on the client's plan, or a Drive folder where the client (or you) saves the aging report each Monday. Email, for drafts.

5. Put it on a schedule:

> **Scheduled task: Monday invoice reminders · Mondays, 9:10am**
>
> **Job:** Draft reminders for overdue invoices. **Read:** the newest accounts receivable aging report in [location]. **Steps:** (1) List each overdue invoice with client, amount and days overdue. (2) Skip [exceptions]. (3) Draft the right reminder from this ladder: [paste ladder]. (4) Put email reminders in the drafts folder. **Deliver:** a table with client, invoice, amount, days overdue and action (draft or call), plus the total overdue. **Never** send, post, delete or change anything. If something you need is missing, say exactly what's missing and stop.

Watch for: invoices paid since the report was run. Check the payments received in the last few days before anything is sent; a reminder for a paid invoice costs goodwill.

Agent 4: Month-End Summary Agent

Runs: Monthly, after the books close · **Needs:** the profit and loss report and cash balance · **Install time:** 30 minutes

What it does: Turns the month's reports into a one-page summary the owner can actually read: revenue, spending, cash, what changed and what to look at, plus a list of questions to ask the bookkeeper.

1. Create a project called "Month-End Summary Agent" in the client's account.

2. Paste these instructions:

> **Instructions: Month-End Summary Agent**
>
> You write the month-end summary for [client name], owner of [business], who is not a finance person.
>
> From the uploaded profit and loss report, last month's report and the cash balance, write: (1) three headline numbers: revenue, profit and cash at month end, each with the change from last month; (2) the three biggest changes in spending, with amounts; (3) anything unusual from the categorizer's flags; (4) three questions to ask the bookkeeper or accountant.
>
> Plain language, one page. Use only numbers from the reports. If something doesn't add up, say so rather than explaining it away. Never give tax advice or tell [name] what to do with money; suggest questions for their accountant instead.

3. Upload: each month's profit and loss report (and the previous month's for comparison).

4. Connect: nothing required. If a read-only accounting connector is available, the agent can pull the reports itself.

Watch for: explanations that sound confident without evidence. The summary should report and ask; the accountant explains.

Part 4: Test before handover

Run every test in the client's account, with their real data, before the handover call. Fix and re-run anything that fails. Keep this table: it goes in your 30-day report as proof the work was checked.

Test	How to run it	Pass if
Receipt matching	Run the chaser on a week where you know which receipts are missing	It finds all of them and doesn't list any that are there
Totals	Run the categorizer on last month's statement	Row count and total match the statement exactly
Categories	Compare 20 categorized transactions with how the bookkeeper coded them last year	At least 18 match; the rest are marked REVIEW
Reminder ladder	Run the reminder agent on the real aging report	Each invoice gets the right step; exceptions are skipped
Summary numbers	Check every number in the month-end summary against the reports	All match; nothing is explained without evidence
Missing information	Give an agent a task with one key fact left out	It says what's missing and stops instead of guessing
Nothing goes out	Check sent mail, posts and records after every test	Nothing was sent, posted, changed or deleted

If the same fix comes up twice, add a rule to that agent's instructions. Agents get better from written rules, not from being told off in a chat.

Part 5: Hand it over

The client guide

Copy this into a one-page document, fill it in and save it in the client's "AI agents" folder. It's the page they'll open when you're not there.

> **Client guide: Your bookkeeping prep agents**
>
> **What's running:** a missing-receipts check every Monday at 10:10am, invoice reminders every Monday at 9:10am, an Expense Categorizer run on the 3rd of each month, and a Month-End Summary once your books close.
>
> **Your daily routine (about 20 minutes on Mondays):** on Monday, check the reminder drafts against any payments you've received since Friday, then send them. Upload any missing receipts the chaser lists. Once a month, read the summary and bring its three questions to your bookkeeper.
>
> **What the agents will never do:** send, post, pay, delete or promise anything without a person approving it.
>
> **When something looks wrong:** don't fix it in the chat. Forward it to [VA name] at [email] with one line on what you expected. I'll update the instructions so it doesn't happen again.
>
> **To pause everything:** turn off the scheduled tasks under Scheduled in your AI account. Nothing else breaks.
>
> **Your monthly report** arrives on the [date] of each month with time saved, what changed and what's next.

The 20-minute handover call

Book it for the morning, when the first scheduled run has just landed, so you can walk through real output.

Minutes	What to do
0 to 3	Recap the problem in their numbers: "This was costing you about [hours] a month."
3 to 10	Open this morning's output together. Show where each agent's work lands and what to do with it.
10 to 15	Have the client approve, edit and send (or post) one item themselves while you watch.
15 to 18	Walk through the client guide: what never happens, what to do when something looks wrong, how to pause.
18 to 20	Agree the first check-in date and when the monthly report arrives.

After the call, send the client guide by email so it's in their inbox, not just their drive.

Part 6: Keep it running

Weekly care checklist (20 to 30 minutes per client)

- ☐ Every scheduled task ran this week. Open each one's history and look for skipped or failed runs.
- ☐ Connections are still signed in. Expired sign-ins are the most common reason an agent goes quiet.
- ☐ Confirm this month's statement exports and aging report are in the folder.
- ☐ Add every new vendor the categorizer marked REVIEW to the vendor list, with the category the bookkeeper used.
- ☐ Check that no reminder went to a client on the exceptions list or for a paid invoice.
- ☐ Every fix the client or reviewer made twice this week is now a written rule in the instructions.
- ☐ Reference files are current (prices, policies, team list, dates).

The 30-day results report

Send this at day 30 and every month after. It's the single best way to keep a care plan: clients cancel what they can't see.

> **Prompt: Monthly results report**
>
> Write a one-page monthly results report for [client], whose bookkeeping prep agents I set up and maintain. Use a friendly, plain tone.
>
> Here's what happened this month: [paste counts, e.g., receipts found, transactions categorized, REVIEW items, reminders sent, overdue amount at start and end of month, invoices paid after a reminder]. Here's what I changed or fixed: [list]. The client's time per task before was [minutes] and is now about [minutes].
>
> Include: (1) one headline sentence with hours and dollars saved this month, using a rate of $[rate]/hour; (2) a short table of each agent, what it handled and time saved; (3) what I improved; (4) one recommendation for next month, with its estimated savings. Don't invent numbers I didn't give you. Under 300 words.

Earn autonomy in stages

After two clean months, the client may want first-step reminders (1 to 7 days overdue) sent without approval, if their email setup allows it, or the categorized file sent straight to the bookkeeper. Keep approval for every reminder past 30 days and anything that touches the books. Write the change into the instructions and the client guide, and agree it with the client by email first.

What to sell next

Once the money admin runs smoothly, owners notice how much of their week is still email. Sell the **Inbox & Calendar Kit** next. If late payments came with complaints or lots of questions, the **Customer Support Kit** is the natural follow-on.

The other client kits

This kit is one of four Done-for-You Client Kits for VAs: **Inbox & Calendar**, **Social Content**, **Bookkeeping Prep** and **Customer Support**. Each one follows the same six parts, so once you've installed one, the next goes faster. Get the others at **virtualexpert.net/kits**.

Want help with your first install, or new workflows every month? The **AI VA Lab** membership adds a new client-ready workflow every month and a live Q&A where you can bring a client situation and get it solved: **virtualexpert.net/membership**.